

WEEK 6

PHYSICAL DESIGN & FINAL SPECIFICATION

Farm Security & Fencing System

Excellence Program 2026

Thematic Area: Security & Fencing

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Preliminary design baseline — subject to site assessment, engineering review, and operational validation.

Contents

- 1. Executive Summary 1
- 2. Week 6 Objective 1
- 3. Design Continuity from Previous Weeks 2
- 4. Risk → Physical Design Traceability 2
- 5. Perimeter & Fencing Concept 3
- 6. Gate & Access-Point Design 4
- 7. Security Zones & Physical Protection 6
- 8. Environmental & Operational Resilience 7
- 9. Preliminary Physical Specification 7
- 10. Layered Security Model 9
- 11. Validation Before Implementation 9
- 12. Design Limitations & Assumptions 10
- 13. References 11

Document status

This report records Week 6 only: the translation of earlier risk, zoning, and access-control findings into a preliminary physical-security design. It is not a final construction or procurement specification.

1. Executive Summary

Week 6 converts the project’s previously identified physical, environmental, and operational risks into a coherent preliminary physical-security baseline for a farm environment. The design is organized around a first physical layer of perimeter fencing, controlled transitions at a small hierarchy of gates, progressively stronger protection across four security levels, and continuity measures for environmental exposure and power interruption. The central design logic is:

Risk → Security requirement → Zone / access need → Physical control → Validation → Implementation

The recommended baseline uses durable, corrosion-protected metallic fencing with rigid anti-climb mesh where intrusion resistance is required; differentiated access points for visitors, staff and operational traffic; protected restricted and critical areas; a project-required 10 m vegetation-free firebreak; and a project-required preliminary target of 72-hour security-system autonomy. The exact dimensions, quantities, foundation details, environmental ratings, and final electrical calculations remain open until the site is measured and reviewed.

Design position

The fence is a delay-and-deter layer, not the complete security solution. A breach of one layer should not automatically produce unrestricted access because gates, zone boundaries, authorization, monitoring, logging, and emergency procedures provide additional control. This defense-in-depth framing is consistent with CISA security-planning guidance [3] [4].

2. Week 6 Objective

The objective is to answer one question: **Given the risks, security zones, and access requirements identified previously, what should the physical security system look like?** The answer is a preliminary design baseline suitable for review, validation planning, and controlled progression toward detailed engineering.

Week 6 focus	Design question	Output in this report
Perimeter	How is the site boundary physically defined and made more resistant to cutting, crossing, and degradation?	Fence concept, inspection space, boundary identification, vegetation control.
Access points	How are visitor, staff, operational, service, and emergency movements separated without creating unnecessary gates?	Gate hierarchy and operating principles.
Zones	How does protection increase with asset sensitivity?	OPEN, CONTROLLED, RESTRICTED, and CRITICAL physical responses.
Resilience	How does the design remain usable through heat, dust, rain, wind, bushfire, and power interruption?	Environmental and power-resilience baseline.
Readiness	What must be verified before construction or procurement?	Validation checklist and limitations.

3. Design Continuity from Previous Weeks

Week 6 is deliberately not a repeat of Weeks 3–5. It uses their outputs as inputs. Week 3 identified the risk and asset context; Week 4 translated that context into security zones and perimeter/access requirements; Week 5 defined how different users and access points should be controlled. Week 6 now specifies the physical response to those already-established needs.

Earlier work	Week 6 input	Physical-design consequence
Week 3: Risk & Asset Analysis	Fence cutting; unauthorized access; bushfire; heat; dust; rain/wind; power outages; operational and seasonal movement; sensitive assets; maintenance.	Use intrusion-resistant perimeter elements, differentiated transitions, environmental protection, backup power, and maintainable details.
Week 4: Security Zoning	Four conceptual levels: OPEN, CONTROLLED, RESTRICTED, CRITICAL.	Increase physical protection and authorization controls as sensitivity increases; keep critical assets away from routine visitor movement.
Week 5: Access Control / Functional Requirements	Different users and access points require different controls.	Use a small gate hierarchy with distinct visitor, staff/operational, and service/emergency functions.
Week 6: Physical Design	The combined risk, zone, and access-control baseline.	Create a preliminary physical-security layout, specification, traceability matrix, and validation plan.

Source and project-decision boundary

NRCS states that its national access-control standard should not be used directly to plan, design, or install a local practice; the local context must be addressed through the applicable Field Office Technical Guide [1]. In this report, official sources support general principles, while dimensions and project targets are labelled as decisions, assumptions, or validation requirements.

4. Risk → Physical Design Traceability

The matrix below makes the Week 6 reasoning auditable. “Expected security function” describes the intended contribution of the physical measure; it does not claim guaranteed security.

Risk	Security requirement	Physical design response	Expected security function
Fence cutting	Intrusion-resistant perimeter	Rigid anti-climb mesh in higher-risk stretches; robust posts; protected fixings; inspection access.	Delay and deter unauthorized crossing; make tampering more visible during inspection.

Risk	Security requirement	Physical design response	Expected security function
Unauthorized access	Controlled transitions	Differentiated gates; zone boundaries; authorization at transitions; visitor route.	Restrict movement to authorized areas and reduce uncontrolled mixing.
Bushfire exposure	Protected perimeter	10 m vegetation-free firebreak as a project requirement; non-combustible perimeter elements where justified.	Reduce combustible fuel immediately around the perimeter, subject to site feasibility.
Extreme heat	Environmental resilience	Outdoor equipment selected for actual site conditions; shade/passive cooling where appropriate; inspection.	Support equipment reliability and reduce heat-related degradation.
Dust / Harmattan	Equipment protection	Weather-resistant or sealed enclosures where appropriate; cleaning intervals and inspection.	Reduce dust ingress and environmental degradation.
Rain / wind	Robust installation	Corrosion protection; robust mounting; site-specific foundations; post-weather inspection.	Maintain alignment, closure, and physical integrity under local exposure.
Power outage	Security continuity	Dedicated backup power sized through final engineering to a preliminary project target of 72-hour autonomy.	Maintain critical security functions during interruption, subject to load calculation and maintenance.
Operational access conflicts	Usable traffic separation	Gate hierarchy, turning-radius validation, clear routes, and emergency access.	Reduce unsafe mixing and prevent security controls from obstructing farm operations.

5. Perimeter & Fencing Concept

The perimeter is the first physical security layer and the boundary condition for all later controls. The preliminary concept is a durable metallic fence system configured to balance intrusion resistance with farm access, visibility, inspection, repair, drainage, and vegetation-management needs. FAO's farm-structures guidance treats fencing and gates in an agricultural context and links them to vehicle access and farm operations [2]. NRCS provides a general access-control reference for barriers, gates, fences, and the control of people, vehicles, and equipment, but its national standard is not a local construction design [1].

Physical element	Preliminary design position	Reason and validation boundary
Fence fabric	Rigid anti-climb mesh where intrusion resistance is required; select durable	Addresses cutting and crossing risk. Final mesh, wire, height, and fixing

Physical element	Preliminary design position	Reason and validation boundary
	metallic construction appropriate to the site.	details require threat, procurement, and engineering review.
Posts and foundations	Robust posts with corrosion protection and foundations adapted to actual soil, terrain, drainage, and wind conditions.	Supports alignment and resilience. No exact post spacing or foundation dimensions are claimed at Week 6.
Inspection area	Maintain a clear inspection and maintenance strip on both sides where practicable.	Improves detection, vegetation control, repair access, and post-weather inspection; width is site-dependent.
Boundary identity	Use clear boundary markers and appropriate security / safety signage at approaches and gates.	Makes the controlled boundary legible to visitors, staff, contractors, and responders.
Agricultural compatibility	Keep fence lines clear of key vehicle routes, drainage paths, turning movements, and routine farm workflows.	Prevents the security system from becoming an operational hazard; confirm through route walk-through.

CONCEPTUAL PERIMETER ARRANGEMENT — NOT TO SCALE		
CRITICAL	Restricted inner boundary	RESTRICTED
Critical infrastructure	controlled transition	Warehouse / equipment / loading
CONTROLLED	production and authorized staff	OPEN
operational perimeter	Main entrance / reception / designated visitor area	Farm boundary: continuous inspection, signage, firebreak and controlled access points
→	Farm boundary	

Conceptual arrangement only. Actual geometry, lengths, gate positions, and inner boundaries require survey, operational validation, and engineering review.

6. Gate & Access-Point Design

A clear gate hierarchy separates movements that have different operational and security needs. The design uses four conceptual access points because they cover the required journeys without multiplying gates for visual complexity. Gate controls should be selected and installed in a manner consistent with the site risk assessment, vehicle movements, and emergency arrangements [1] [2] [4].

Gate	Purpose / users	Access and zone relationship	Physical-control principle
A. Main Entrance	Primary arrival, reception, and general orientation.	Public-facing approach into OPEN areas; transition toward CONTROLLED areas is separate.	Legible entrance, controlled vehicle/pedestrian interface, registration point, signage, and a gate arrangement that can be supervised without obstructing farm traffic.
B. Visitor Gate	Pre-authorized visitors, contractors, and escorted guests.	Feeds the designated visitor route and authorized visitor area; no routine entry into RESTRICTED or CRITICAL zones.	Verify identity and purpose; provide safety briefing; use a controlled pedestrian/vehicle transition; record entry and exit where required.
C. Staff / Operational Gate	Authorized staff, seasonal workforce, and farm-operational traffic.	Direct connection to CONTROLLED operational areas; access is based on role and operational need.	Avoid visitor mixing; provide practical throughput for farm movements; coordinate access windows with production activities.
D. Service / Emergency Gate	Service vehicles, emergency responders, and approved maintenance access.	Normally controlled and kept clear; provides a resilient route to relevant operational and CRITICAL areas when authorized.	Use robust hardware, emergency override arrangements, clear approach geometry, and a documented inspection/test regime.

Realistic visitor journey

Visitor arrives → registration / verification → safety briefing → designated visitor route → authorized visitor area → exit / check-out. Sensitive operational areas remain restricted unless specific authorization exists.

Movement interface	Design rule	Validation question
Visitors and staff	Do not rely on a shared route when it would expose restricted operations or create supervision ambiguity.	Can the visitor journey be completed without entering production, warehouse, loading, equipment, or critical-infrastructure areas?
Operational vehicles	Prioritize turning, queueing, and safe clearance without weakening zone control.	What vehicle types, seasonal peaks, and turning radii must the gate support?

Movement interface	Design rule	Validation question
Emergency access	Keep the emergency/service route available and operationally understood; do not treat it as an uncontrolled bypass.	Can responders reach the required zone while normal access controls remain accountable?

7. Security Zones & Physical Protection

The four conceptual security levels remain the organizing principle. Protection increases with sensitivity, and authorization becomes more specific as movement proceeds inward. This zoning approach is a project continuity decision from Week 4, not a newly invented Week 6 classification.

Level	Typical farm areas	Physical-protection response	Movement rule
OPEN	Entrance, reception, designated visitor areas.	Visible boundary, clear signage, supervised approach, basic separation from controlled operations.	Visitors may remain only on the designated route and authorized areas.
CONTROLLED	Operational / production areas; authorized staff.	Controlled gate or transition, role-based authorization, route definition, and monitoring/logging where required.	Staff and approved operational users only; visitors require specific authorization and escort as applicable.
RESTRICTED	Warehouse, equipment, loading, sensitive operational areas.	Stronger physical separation, limited gate permissions, controlled keys/credentials, and increased supervision.	Need-to-enter access only; no routine visitor entry.
CRITICAL	Critical infrastructure and highest-value / most sensitive assets.	Highest level of physical separation and authorization; resilient access route, monitoring, and emergency procedure.	Specific authorization only; access is exceptional and accountable.

Protection gradient

OPEN → CONTROLLED → RESTRICTED → CRITICAL

From legible boundary and supervised access to specific authorization, stronger separation, monitoring, and resilient emergency arrangements.

8. Environmental & Operational Resilience

Farm security must remain usable and maintainable in the actual environmental and operational context. The measures below are project design responses to the risks already identified in earlier weeks; they are not claims that a particular product or rating has been verified.

Condition	Design response	Validation / maintenance requirement
Extreme heat	Select outdoor equipment for actual operating temperatures; use shade or passive cooling where appropriate; avoid unsupported exact ratings.	Confirm local exposure, equipment data sheets, enclosure temperature, inspection frequency, and replacement capability.
Harmattan / dust	Use weather-resistant or sealed enclosures where appropriate; protect optical/electronic equipment; plan cleaning.	Confirm dust exposure, seals, cleaning access, spare parts, and inspection intervals.
Heavy rain / wind	Use corrosion protection, robust mounting, drainage-aware installation, and foundations matched to site conditions.	Assess wind exposure, drainage, soil, mounting loads, and post-weather inspection.
Bushfire	Maintain the previously established 10 m vegetation-free firebreak as a project requirement; use non-combustible physical elements where justified.	Validate feasibility with site conditions, access for vegetation management, fire planning, and applicable local requirements.
Power outages	Provide dedicated security backup power; retain the previous 72-hour autonomy target as a preliminary project requirement, not a final electrical calculation.	Complete load schedule, battery sizing, autonomy test, recharge plan, alarm/monitoring behaviour, and maintenance plan.
Farm operations	Avoid blocking crop, livestock, loading, service, and emergency movements; keep inspection and repair practical.	Walk routes with operators, test seasonal scenarios, and confirm vehicle envelopes and pedestrian safety.

9. Preliminary Physical Specification

This table is a design baseline for review. It is intentionally not a procurement specification. “Preliminary specification” describes the intended performance and configuration direction; exact products, dimensions, quantities, and ratings require validation.

Component	Preliminary specification	Security purpose	Risk addressed	Validation required
Perimeter fence	Rigid anti-climb mesh where needed; durable metallic construction;	Delay, deter, define, and	Fence cutting; unauthorized access;	Site survey; threat review; soil/terrain; drainage;

Component	Preliminary specification	Security purpose	Risk addressed	Validation required
	corrosion protection; clear inspection strip; compatible with farm routes.	make tampering observable.	environmental degradation.	final dimensions; engineering and local procurement.
Fence posts	Robust, corrosion-protected posts; foundation concept adapted to soil, terrain, drainage, and wind exposure.	Maintain fence alignment and resistance to local loads.	Cutting; rain/wind; maintenance.	Geotechnical/soil review; structural design; post spacing and foundation details; installation method.
Gates	Four conceptual functions: main entrance, visitor, staff/operational, service/emergency; robust hardware and accountable control.	Create controlled transitions and separate movements.	Unauthorized access; operational conflicts; emergency access.	Exact locations; turning radii; pedestrian safety; throughput; emergency procedure; hardware selection.
Boundary signage	Clear boundary, safety, visitor, and access-direction signage at approaches and transitions.	Make rules and boundaries legible.	Unauthorized access; visitor confusion; operational conflict.	Language, placement, visibility, durability, and applicable requirements.
Firebreak	10 m vegetation-free firebreak retained as a project requirement; feasibility to be checked on site.	Reduce combustible fuel at perimeter.	Bushfire exposure.	Measure available width; confirm vegetation-management plan, drainage, access, and local fire guidance.
Outdoor security equipment	Weather-resistant/sealed enclosures where appropriate; shade/passive cooling; robust mounting; cleaning and inspection.	Support detection, authorization, monitoring, and logging.	Heat; dust; rain/wind; maintenance.	Operating environment; enclosure and mounting data; visibility; cleaning; spares; test plan.
Security power	Dedicated backup power with preliminary target of 72-hour autonomy; final sizing	Maintain critical functions during outages.	Power depletion; outages.	Load calculation; battery sizing; recharge; autonomy test; alarm behaviour; lifecycle and maintenance.

Component	Preliminary specification	Security purpose	Risk addressed	Validation required
	and load schedule pending.			
Maintenance	Routine inspection, vegetation management, post-weather checks, gate tests, cleaning, and defect escalation.	Preserve intended physical performance over time.	Maintenance requirements; environmental degradation; all physical controls.	Assign owner; frequency; records; access to repair areas; spare parts and service capability.

10. Layered Security Model

The physical design is part of a defense-in-depth system. CISA guidance supports planning that combines risk assessment, emergency planning, layered security, and appropriately installed active and passive barriers [3] [4].

The project's six layers are:

Layer	Control	Contribution to resilience
1	Perimeter / fencing	Defines the boundary, delays crossing, supports inspection, and creates a physical basis for zoning.
2	Controlled gates	Controls transitions for visitors, staff, operations, service, and emergency access.
3	Security zoning	Increases protection as assets become more sensitive and keeps routine visitor movement outward.
4	Access authorization	Connects entry to role, purpose, timing, and specific area need.
5	Monitoring / access logging	Improves accountability, detection, review, and incident reconstruction where implemented.
6	Emergency procedures	Provides a managed response for fire, outage, medical, service, and other urgent conditions.

Fence → Gate → Zone → Authorization → Monitoring → Emergency Response

11. Validation Before Implementation

Week 6 creates a preliminary physical-design baseline. It does not authorize construction or procurement. Before final design, construction, or purchasing, validate the following with the farm operator, relevant technical specialists, and applicable authorities.

Validation topic	What must be confirmed	Owner / evidence
Perimeter measurements	Actual boundary length, corners, gradients, interfaces, existing assets, and inspection access.	Survey / as-built record

Validation topic	What must be confirmed	Owner / evidence
Gate locations	Exact placement, sightlines, queueing, safety, relationship to zones, and service/emergency access.	Site walk / layout
Vehicle movement	Turning radius, vehicle envelope, seasonal traffic, loading, crop/livestock logistics, and conflict points.	Operator / route test
Pedestrian and visitor routes	Safe route, registration, briefing, escort, authorized areas, exit/check-out, and separation from sensitive operations.	Walk-through / procedure
Soil, terrain, drainage	Foundation conditions, erosion, runoff, water paths, and local installation constraints.	Site / engineering assessment
Firebreak feasibility	Whether the 10 m vegetation-free firebreak can be established and maintained without creating operational or environmental conflicts.	Fire / site review
Environmental exposure	Heat, dust, rain, wind, corrosion, visibility, enclosure conditions, and maintenance access.	Exposure review / datasheets
Power resilience	Final loads, critical functions, backup architecture, 72-hour calculation, recharge, testing, and maintenance.	Electrical design / test
Procurement and maintenance	Local availability, lead times, spare parts, skills, tools, cleaning, inspection, and defect response.	Operations / procurement
Regulations and engineering	Applicable regulations, permits, structural requirements, fire requirements, and professional sign-off.	Compliance / engineering
Final quantities and dimensions	Fence lengths, gate sizes, post spacing, foundations, equipment counts, signage, and quantities.	Approved final design

Non-negotiable distinction

PRELIMINARY DESIGN ≠ FINAL CONSTRUCTION DESIGN. Exact fence height, post spacing, foundation dimensions, gate dimensions, total fence length, equipment ratings, and backup-power sizing are not verified site facts in this Week 6 report.

12. Design Limitations & Assumptions

The following limitations protect the integrity of the design baseline.

Classification	Statement
Source-supported information	Official sources support general access-control, agricultural-fencing, vehicle-access, layered-security, and barrier principles [1] [2] [3] [4].

Classification	Statement
Project decision	Retain four conceptual security levels; use four gate functions; maintain the 10 m firebreak requirement; retain the 72-hour security autonomy target as a preliminary project requirement.
Preliminary assumption	The farm can provide a continuous boundary, inspection access, differentiated transitions, a workable emergency/service route, and maintenance capability. These assumptions require site confirmation.
Site validation requirement	All geometry, quantities, dimensions, soil/foundation details, drainage, exact environmental ratings, electrical calculations, local procurement, regulations, and engineering sign-off must be confirmed before implementation.
Security limitation	The design is risk-based and layered; it does not guarantee security and must be supported by procedures, trained personnel, maintenance, monitoring, and response capability.

13. References

- [1] USDA Natural Resources Conservation Service. **Access Control (Ac.) (472) Conservation Practice Standard**. National standard page, updated 2026. Official URL: nrcs.usda.gov. Access date: 27 August 2026. Used for general access-control, barrier, gate, fence, and movement-control principles; the page's local-use warning is explicitly observed in this report.
- [2] Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. **Farm Structures — Chapter 13: External Facilities: Vehicle Access to Farmsteads; Fencing; Types of Fences; Fencing Accessories**. Official URL: fao.org. Access date: 27 August 2026. Used for agricultural fencing, gates, fencing accessories, and vehicle-access context.
- [3] Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency. **Security Planning Workbook**. September 2023. Official URL: cisa.gov. Access date: 27 August 2026. Used for security planning, layered protection, perimeter concepts, and physical-protection framing.
- [4] Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency. **Vehicle Incident Prevention and Mitigation Security Guide**. 23 April 2024. Official URL: cisa.gov. Access date: 27 August 2026. Used for risk-based planning, emergency planning, traffic-management considerations, layered security, and active/passive barrier principles.

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